

MILITARY SEALIFT COMMAND N3220526R6063

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

16 April 2026

The following are answers to questions received from potential offerors. The answers provide clarification only and DO NOT constitute an amendment to the solicitation.

1. Please advise if there is a maximum vessel age for this requirement.

ANSWER – There is no maximum age for this requirement.

2. The multiple sources sought for this mission allowed for U.S. or Foreign Flag vessels, but the RFP is a U.S. Flag only requirement. Please be advised that the U.S. Coast Guard (USCG) National Vessel Documentation Center (NVDC), which processes the paper for vessel sales/purchases and reflagging is currently closed due to the DHS partial shutdown. We therefore request that MSC place this procurement in suspense at least until this situation is resolved.

ANSWER – At this time, MSC cannot place this procurement in suspense.

3. Further to Question #2 above, the vessels contemplated for this requirement are likely not eligible for an expedited MSP reflag due to the size, military utility and likely age of the vessel. Therefore, the estimated timeline for reflag is 6-9 months after award. Accordingly, we are requesting that MSC consider adjusting the lay/can window to accommodate reflag vessels.

ANSWER – MSC recognizes estimated time to reflag is 6-9 months; however, due to mission requirements the lay/can window cannot be adjusted.

To use the streamlined process, Owners/Offerors would have to enroll in VTA/VISA with MARAD which may invoke a military utility determination. USCG would need that determination to move quickly, typically 60 days if all is in order, i.e., full set of statutory certs that have been maintained. The actual inspection of the vessel is typically 3 or so days. The key to success is that the vessel is in compliance and in good condition. Recommend reviewing the USCG website for: REFLAG FOREIGN VESSELS specifically, NVIC 1-13 CH 2 and the QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE.